DESIGN REVIEW REPORT

LinkedIn Mobile Application

An evaluation of UI & UX design across networking, content, jobs and professional identity

1B+	200+	4.2/5
Members worldwide	Countries & regions	Overall rating

Category: Professional Networking • Platform: Android & iOS

01 · INTRODUCTION

What is LinkedIn?

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. It lets users build a profile, connect with colleagues, share posts and articles, follow companies, search and apply for jobs, message contacts, and join professional Groups and Events.

The main goal of LinkedIn's design is to help people build their professional identity, grow meaningful connections, and find opportunities.

BY THE NUMBERS

1,000,000,000+

members globally

200+

countries & regions

6+

core surfaces: Feed, Jobs, Messaging, Notifications, Groups, Learning

Design goal: help people build their professional identity, grow meaningful connections, and find opportunities.

UI vs. UX

UI — User Interface

Everything the user sees and interacts with in the app.

- Buttons & icons
- Colors & typography
- Feed cards
- Navigation bar
- Profile photos
- Search bar

UX — User Experience

How easy, useful, and rewarding the app feels to use.

EXAMPLE TASK: Connect with a colleague

1. Open LinkedIn
2. Search their name
3. Open their profile
4. Tap Connect
5. Add a short note
6. Request is sent

A guided flow that takes seconds to complete.

Key UI Elements

LinkedIn pairs a confident brand blue with card-based content, clear iconography and a persistent bottom navigation bar.

Color

LinkedIn blue is the primary brand color

Icons

Jobs, messaging, notifications, search

Typography

Clean, professional and readable text

Feed Cards

Posts, articles and media in card format

Navigation

Home, My Network, Jobs, Messaging, Notifications

Buttons

Clear actions: Connect, Follow, Apply

Profile Photos

Headshots, banners and company logos

Search Bar

People, jobs, posts and companies

03 · UX FEATURES

Designed to Build Your Network

Guided Onboarding

Imports work history, education and contacts to suggest connections and jump-start a complete profile.

Easy Navigation

Home, My Network, Jobs, Messaging and Notifications sit in one persistent bottom bar.

Familiar Icons

Connect, message, like, comment and share icons make actions instantly recognizable.

Feedback, Privacy & Trust

Feedback to Users

Reactions, comments, connection status, message seen-state and notification badges

- ✓ Connection request sent
- ✓✓ Message delivered
- ✓✓ Message seen (timestamped)

Confirms exactly where a request or message stands.

Privacy & Trust

Users control how visible their profile and activity are to their network and the wider public.

- Profile viewing options
- Connection visibility controls
- Who can message you
- Ad & data privacy settings

Rich Content & Professional Communities

Users can easily share and engage with:

- **Posts**
- **Articles**
- **Video**
- **Documents**
- **Polls**
- **Events**
- **Reactions**
- **Reposts**

This turns the feed into a two-way space for ideas, updates and career moments.

Jobs & Groups

Personalized job recommendations, one-tap applications, and Groups/Communities organized around industries, alumni and interests.

UI vs. UX in LinkedIn

UI ELEMENT	RESULTING UX
Blue brand color	Creates a trustworthy, professional identity
Feed cards	Makes scanning content easy and structured
Connect icon	Makes growing a network easy to discover
Jobs tab	Provides quick access to opportunities
Profile photos & banners	Helps identify people and companies
Bottom navigation	Makes major features easy to access
Reactions & comments	Gives feedback on engagement
Privacy controls	Gives users control and confidence

05 · EVALUATION

Strengths of LinkedIn Design

Clear Structure

Card-based feed keeps content organized and scannable.

Strong Job Discovery

Personalized matches and one-tap Easy Apply speed up job hunting.

Consistent Design

Icons, cards and buttons behave predictably across the app.

Clear Feedback

Reactions, badges and status updates show activity clearly.

Familiar Patterns

Social-app conventions reduce the learning curve.

Privacy-Focused

Granular visibility controls build professional trust.

05 · EVALUATION

Weaknesses & Areas for Improvement

Feature Overload

Feed, Jobs, Learning, Groups, Newsletters and ads compete for attention on one home screen.

Feed Noise

Sponsored posts and algorithmic suggestions can crowd out updates from close connections.

Complex Settings

Privacy and notification settings span many menus, which can overwhelm new users.

Messaging Clutter

InMail, recruiter messages and spam-like outreach can make the inbox hard to manage.

06 · RECOMMENDATIONS

Suggested Improvements

1	**Feed Controls**	Let users prioritize posts from close connections over sponsored and suggested content.
2	**Smarter Inbox Filters**	Separate recruiter/InMail messages from personal conversations by default.
3	**Simpler First-Run Guidance**	Short tooltips or a small interactive tour when a feature is used for the first time.
4	**Clearer Privacy Center**	Consolidate scattered privacy options into one plain-language settings hub.
5	**Better Personalization**	Let users fine-tune job recommendations and content topics more directly.

07 · JOURNEY MAP

User Journey — Apply to a Job



Low	Easy	Good	Low
MAJOR STEPS	DIFFICULTY	FEEDBACK	LEARNING NEEDED

Overall experience: efficient, with pre-filled applications and clear confirmation at the end.

08 · SCORECARD

Overall Design Evaluation



OVERALL RATING

4.2

out of 5

09 · CONCLUSION

A Strong Example of Professional-Grade UI & UX

Its card-based feed, clear iconography, strong job-discovery flow and layered privacy controls make LinkedIn accessible to a huge, globally diverse professional audience.

> *"Good design should make professional growth feel simple, structured, and worth returning to."*

As LinkedIn has grown into content, learning and commerce, future improvements should focus on reducing feed noise, simplifying settings, and decluttering messaging.

4.2 / 5

OVERALL RATING